Follow the Citation

Lesson 2: from an answer to a real book on a real shelf.

Check the Source · 45 minutes

Last time

The banner says: check the source.

What is the source?

> The source is the **Record**, and behind the Record is a real book.

The anatomy of an answer

1. The overview

Volcanoes form where melted rock rises through Earth's crust and erupts at the surface.

The model's own words. No Citations, on purpose.

2. Books in our library

Citation: *Volcanoes* (551.21 SIM)

Nonfiction, the 500s (science, animals, and math): find 551.21, then SIM

Straight from the Catalog, so it can't be made up.

An example of the layout. Now let's try a real one.

What's in a Record

A **Record** describes a book: **title**, **author**, **subjects**, **summary**, and **call number**.

> A Record is **not** the book. It also doesn't say whether the book is on the shelf right now.

The one line about why a book was picked is the model talking, so check that too.

Two different sentences

"The assistant said it"

The model's words. Maybe true. Not checked yet.

"The Record says it"

Our Catalog's words about a real book. Now go and look at the book.

The trail

1

Citation

Title and call number

2

Record

What the book is about

3

Call number

Where it lives

4

Shelf

The real book

Your turn: Citation relay

Ask three questions from the list. For each answer:

- The **typer** asks.
- The **reader** reads the overview aloud.
- The **checker** opens the Citations and copies title and call number.
- The **runner** goes to the shelf.
- The **recorder** fills in the Citation trail on the back of your handout.

Book checked out? Mark it. That still counts: the Record is real.

What did you find?

- Did every book in Books in our library turn out to be **real**?
- Did the books seem to be about **what the overview said**?

> A Citation proves the book is real and that we own it. It doesn't prove the overview is right.